23. Assertion (A) : The percentage of net sown area in the total area of Andhra Pradesh is less as compared to that of West Bengal.

Reason (R) : The soil of most of Andhra Pradesh is laterite.

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is correct but R is wrong.
(d) A is wrong but R is correct.

Ans. (c) : Assertion is true but Reason is false. Net sown area of Andhra Pradesh is 40% and West Bengal has 60%. So the assertion is correct. But the reason is false because the alluvial soil is only found across delta of rivers of the Godavari the Krishna and the Cauvery of Andhra Pradesh.

24. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

Monastery	State
(a) Dhankar Monastery	: Himachal Pradesh
(b) Rumtek Monastery	: Sikkim
(c) Tabo Monastery	: Himachal Pradesh
(d) Kye Monaster	: Arunachal Pradesh

Ans. (d) : Dhankar Monastery is present at 12,774 feet above sea level of Lahaul and Spiti of Himachal Pradesh. Rumtek monastery is important and largest monastery of Sikkim, 24 km away from Gangtok. Tabo monastery is situated at a distance of about 50 kilometres from Kaza in Lahual district of Himachal Pradesh. Kye Monastery is situated 12 kms north of Kaza of Himachal Pradesh, not in Arunachal Pradesh.

25. Match List-I (Valley) with List-II (State) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the Lists:

List-I (Valley)	List-II (State)
A. Markha Valley	1. Sikkim
B. Dzukou Valley	2. Himachal Pradesh
C. Sangla Valley	3. Jammu and Kashmir
D. Yumthang Valley	4. Nagaland

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	3	1
(b)	3	1	2	4
(c)	2	1	3	4
(d)	3	4	2	1

Ans. (d) : A-3; B-4; C-2; D-1

26. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

(a) Mahanadi River rises in Chhattisgarh
(b) Godavari River rises in Maharashtra
(c) Cauvery River rises in Andhra Pradesh
(d) Tapti River rises in Madhya Pradesh

Ans. (c) : Cauvery river originates in the foothills of Western Ghats at Talakaveri, Kodagu in Karnataka. It flows generally south and east through Karnataka and Tamil Nadu and across the southern Deccan plateau through the southeastern lowlands, emptying into the Bay of Bengal through two principal mouths in Poompuhar, Tamil Nadu.

27. Where is the Central Water and Power Research Station located?

(a) Khadakwasla (b) Sileru
(c) Jamnagar (d) Srisailam

Ans. (a) : Central Water and Power Research Station was established in the year 1916 in Khadakwasla, Pune by the then Bombay Presidency as a Special Irrigation Cell. It is the Premier Research and Development (R & D) organisation and is a subordinate office under Ministry of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation.

28. Which one of the following companies is associated with the exploration and commercial production of oil in Barmer-Sanchore basin of Rajasthan?

(a) Cairn Energy
(b) Unocal Corporation
(c) Reliance Energy Ventures
(d) ONGC

Ans. (a) : Cairn Energy PLC is one of the leading independent exploration and development companies for oil and gas in Europe and is listed on the London Stock Exchange. It is linked to the exploration and commercial production of oil in Rajasthan's Barmer-Sanchore basin. The 25-year contract for oil and gas exploration and production from the Cairn India Barmer oil block in Rajasthan, in which ONGC holds a 30% interest, was due to be renewed in 2020.

29. Which of the following substances are found in the beach sands of many parts of Kerala?

1. Ilmenite
2. Zircon
3. Sillimanite
4. Tungsten

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1 and 2 only

Ans. (b) : Ilmenite, Zircon and Silimanite are found in the beach sands of many parts of Kerala.

30. Match List-I (Centre of Handicrafts) with List-II (State) and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists:

List-I (Centre of Handicrafts)	List-II (State)
A. Mon	1. Arunachal Pradesh
B. Nalbari	2. Assam
C. Pasighat	3. Meghalaya
D. Tura	4. Nagaland

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	5	3	2	3
(b)	1	3	4	2
(c)	4	2	1	3
(d)	1	2	4	3

Ans. (c) : A-4; B-2; C-1; D-3

31. Match List-I (National Park/Wildlife Sanctuary) with List-II (Nearby Town) and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists:

List-I (National Park/Wildlife Sanctuary)	List-II (Nearby Town)
A. Chandra Prabha	1. Jaipur
B. Karera	2. Jhansi
C. Jaisamand	3. Agra
D. Nahargarh	4. Varanasi
	5. Udaipur

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	1	5	2
(b)	5	2	3	1
(c)	4	2	5	1
(d)	5	1	3	2

Ans. (c) : A-4; B-2; C-5; D-1

32. From north toward south, which one of the following is the correct sequence of the given rivers in India?

(a) Shyok-Spiti-Zaskar-Satluj
(b) Shyok-Zaskar-Spiti-Satluj
(c) Zaskar-Shyok-Satluj-Spiti
(d) Zaskar-Satluj-Shyok-Spiti

Ans. (b) : The correct sequence of the rivers in India from north towards south is Shyok – Zaskar – Spiti – Satluj. Shyok flows through northern Ladakh in India. Zaskar River flows in north-eastern part of Ladakh. Spiti River is situated at Kaza in Himachal Pradesh at an elevation of 12500 feet. Satluj River rises from slopes of Kailash and flows in south-westerly direction to Himachal Pradesh & Punjab.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

33. Bermuda triangle extend up to which of the following places?

1. Southern Florida
2. Puerto Rico
3. Hawali Islands

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2, only
(c) 2 and 3, only (d) 1 and 3, only

Ans. (b) : The Bermuda Triangle, a mysterious stretch of ocean between Bermuda, Puerto Rico and the tip of Florida, has allegedly, throughout the years, swallowed a horde of unsuspecting ships, planes and people.

34. Which one of the following countries is not a member of the Nordic Council?

(a) Norway (b) Denmark
(c) Iceland (d) United Kingdom

Ans. (d) : The Nordic Council is a geo-political inter-parliamentary forum for co-operation between the Nordic countries. It was formed after the Second World War in 1952 to promote co-operation between the five Nordic countries - Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway and Sweden.

35. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

(a) Slovenia	: Bratislava
(b) Seychelles	: Victoria
(c) Sierra Leone	: Freetown
(d) Uzbekistan	: Tashkent

Ans. (a) : Slovenia - Ljubljana, Seychelles - Victoria Sierra Leone-Freetown, Uzbekistan - Tashkent. Bratislava is the capital of Slovakia.

36. Consider the following statements:

1. Length of a terrestrial mile is lesser than that of a nautical mile.

2. Harmattan is a dusty land-wind of the East African Coast.

3. Greece and Albania form a part of the Iberian Peninsula.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1 only

Ans. (d) : One nautical mile is 1852 meters and one terrestrial mile is 1609 metres. So, statement '1' is correct. Harmattan is a dry and dusty wind of West Africa. So, statement '2' is wrong. Iberian peninsula includes Portugal, Spain, Andorra and Gibraltar. Greece and Albania are not a part of Peninsula. So, statement '3' is wrong.